

in the Pro version, Metacontact lets you collect the different account names of the same person in different networks under one entry. The names are in tree format, which can be expanded or collapsed. Saving records of conversations or other activities is strongly supported in Trillian: log files can be stored either in text format or in XML. Saving history in XML is particularly useful as chats can be easily searched.

Instant lookup is a great feature in Trillian which ensures that you do not need to display your ignorance any longer. Say you're talking with a friend of yours who is a bit of a history buff. So when in the middle of discussion about a recently-released movie he says Operation Barbarossa was one of the greatest mistakes in history, you need not scratch your head: Trillian uses real-time referencing against Wikipedia, and such names and terms appear with a green underline and are looked up in Wikipedia for a brief definition. So even if you didn't know what Operation Barbarossa was, you could chip in saying Hitler was probably acting on astrologers instead of his army commanders...

Emotiblips is another unique feature of Trillian, which can be described as the video equivalent of an emoticon. Emotiblips lets users send songs or video clips to contacts during video chat sessions. Supported file formats are MP3, WAV, WMV and MPEG. File transfer is available in Trillian, too, and you can configure your anti-virus software to scan all incoming files.

4.2.3 Miranda

A light and customisable IM client designed for Windows, Miranda is available for free under the GPL. Miranda is basically a graphical interface and plugin architecture where all features are installed as plugins. This enables the software to consume minimal system resources and yet provide desired functionality. It supports a large number of IM protocols services like Yahoo!, Jabber, MSN, AIM, Gadu-Gadu, Skype, etc. Get Miranda from <http://www.miranda-im.org/download/>. The downloaded package provides support for major protocols, while addition protocol support can be obtained by downloading add-ons from <http://addons.miranda-im.org/>. Whatever service you are using, you